

NOT QUITE ENOUGH Congress leader Rahul Gandhi at a rally in Ambala, Sept. 30

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ASSEMBLY POLLS 2024

CONGRESS

LESSONS NOT LEARNT

THE GRAND OLD PARTY'S SELF-DEFEATING MOVES LEAD TO ANOTHER LOSS IN HARYANA. IF IT DOES NOT RIGHT ITS SHIP IN TIME, ITS PROSPECTS COULD SINK IN MAHARASHTRA AND JHARKHAND TOO

By KAUSHIK DEKA

THE CONGRESS PARTY'S STUNNING DEFEAT in Haryana, a state it was widely expected to win, and its below-par performance in Jammu and Kashmir, signify more than just a temporary stumble. These setbacks have again exposed the deeper structural flaws that plague the party. In Haryana, the Congress secured 37 seats in the 90-member assembly, losing an election supporters and even opponents presumed would be a straightforward win. In J&K, the party won only six of the 32 seats it contested and will be part of the government only because of the strong showing by its ally, the National Conference.

These results puncture the narrative that the Congress is on a revival path after its much improved Lok Sabha election tally in May. They also underscore how sporadic victories, such as in Karnataka, Himachal Pradesh and Telangana, combined with